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# ● ● ● Barrismo Social

Alianza del Pacífico 2024 →

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I joined a regional volunteering program in Medellín and Pasto, where we explored Barrismo Social—a grassroots movement turning football fan culture into a tool for peacebuilding. Through shared stories and local projects, I saw how passion for football can break barriers, challenge stigma, and spark real community change.



**Photo of the program's female volunteers. Peru, Colombia, Mexico, and Chile**

During our first week in Medellin, we visited La Escuelita, a grassroots school offering music, dance, and art workshops in a low-income neighborhood. It's a powerful example of resilience and creativity. Inspired by their work, I wrote an article about how small community initiatives like this can use simple indicators to measure their impact and grow stronger.



**Volunteers sitting to carry out a dynamic**



We visited Moravia, a neighborhood that was once a city landfill and is now a vibrant space filled with culture and community. Art, resilience, and collective action turned it into a living example of transformation. Moravia shows what's possible when a community dares to imagine something better—and works together to build it.



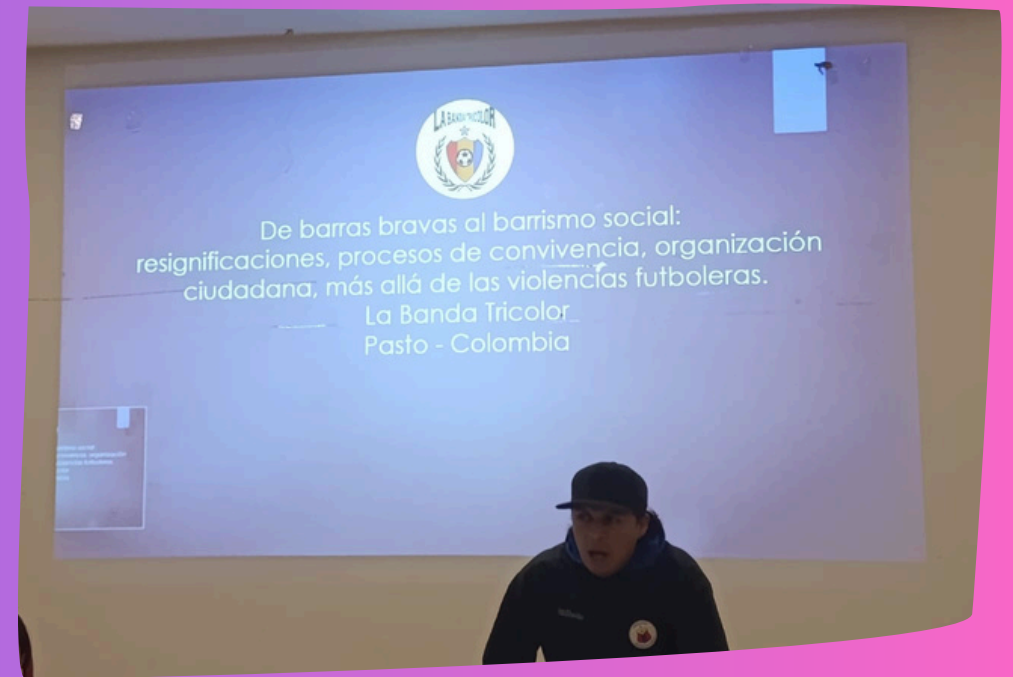
**Photos of the Moravia Cultural Center. The neighborhood's beginnings.**

We visited the stadium and met young people whose lives were transformed through community work within football fan groups. They learned that rivalry doesn't have to mean violence. Through dialogue and teamwork, they created a safe, inclusive space where passion fuels peace—not conflict.



**Photos at the stadium.**

In Pasto, we witnessed how football fan groups lead real community change. During a drought, they collected bottles of water as part of the entrance to the stadium and delivered them to affected areas. Their story showed us that passion, when organized, can turn into solidarity and hope.



**Photo of a member of a football fan club explaining the organization.**

Also in Pasto, we connected with fan group leaders from different cities and explored ways to build healthier football communities. Through teamwork and open dialogue, we shared ideas on how to turn football into a tool for inclusion, not division. It was a powerful reminder that collective change starts with shared goals.



**Conference room at the stadium in Pasto with fellow volunteers**



This experience changed the way I see football. In Colombia, I saw how fan groups became agents of peace and social impact. Back in Peru, where violence still surrounds football culture, I realize there's still much to do. But now I know: transformation is possible—when passion meets purpose.



**Photos of the closing ceremony with  
volunteers from Peru**



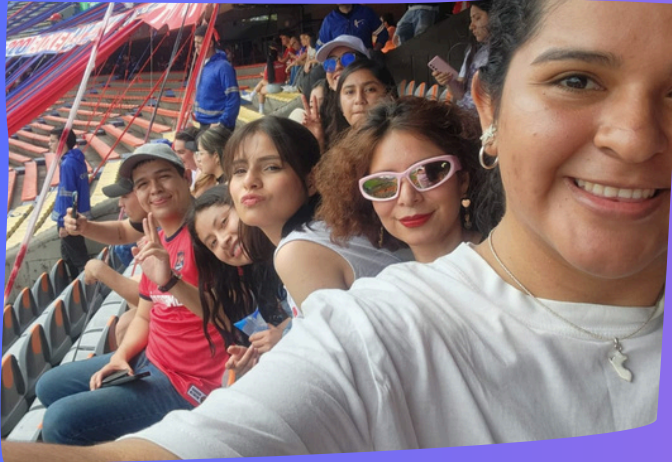
Developed by Ignacio Alcavil Guerrero, Verónica Martínez Maldonado, and Carolina Saavedra Peña, Oasis Cultural is a community-driven initiative to transform neighborhood football fields into shaded, multifunctional spaces. Using recycled clothes and fabrics, the project promotes sustainable construction, community-led design, and inclusive activities such as workshops on human rights, mental health, and local history—turning public spaces into hubs for learning and connection.



**Closure project: Oasis Cultural**

# More photos

At the stadium in Pasto



Sharing a coffee among  
volunteers



Pins of Sporting Cristal, Deportivo Independiente  
de Medellin and the Barra Tricolor.  
(left to right)



At the stadium in Medellin